

MATTHEW O'LEARY | Production Designer & Manager

Santa Cruz, CA | 831-275-2566 | matt@mattoleary.design | mattoleary.design | [linkedin.com/in/matt-oleary](https://www.linkedin.com/in/matt-oleary)

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Production Designer & Manager with 20+ years of experience across magazine publishing, CPG packaging, and large-scale print production. Currently managing end-to-end design and layout for California magazine – maintaining typographic consistency and the vendor relationship from initial draft to press. Experienced in prepress workflows, multi-SKU retail rollouts, dielines, and color separations, with a strong track record of on-time, on-spec delivery.

CORE SKILLS

Publishing & Editorial: Magazine & Custom Publication Design, Page Mapping & Imposition, Book Interior & Cover Systems, Typography, Layout Systems & Visual Hierarchy, Proofing & Stakeholder Approval Cycles

Production & Vendor Management: Printer & Vendor Relationship Management, Press Checks & Quality Control, Preflight (PDF/X), Print Order & Paper Specification Coordination, Prepress Workflow Management

Packaging & Collateral: CPG Packaging Design, Rigid & Flexible Dieline Management, Color Separations, FDA-Compliant Copy Placement, Branded Collateral, Multi-SKU Retail Rollouts

Project & Workflow Tools: Airtable, Trello, Asset Management Systems, Digital Delivery Pipelines

Workflow: Independent Project Execution, Cross-Functional Collaboration, High-Volume Output, Fast-Turnaround Delivery

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

California Magazine (Cal Alumni Association) – Graphic Designer & Production Manager

Remote (Contract) | Aug 2026 – Present

Lead layout design, image placement, and asset production for California magazine, maintaining visual and typographic consistency across editorial pages, ads, and custom inserts. Manage the relationship with the print vendor (Quad), overseeing the workflow from press-ready file delivery through final proof approval. Route layouts and proofs through the Design Director and editorial approval cycles, coordinating revisions under publishing deadlines. Produce post-print digital and web-optimized promotional assets to support cross-channel marketing.

Matt O'Leary Design – Freelance Graphic Designer & Production Consultant

Santa Cruz, CA | 2010 – Present

Design and execute press-ready and digital assets for client accounts, managing

projects independently from initial creative brief through final production delivery. Develop FDA-compliant packaging mechanicals and layout systems in line with manufacturing requirements. Coordinate with external printers and fabrication vendors on quality control, material specs, and final delivery, tracking project timelines in Trello.

OBXtek – Production Support Specialist

Monterey, CA | Dec 2024 – Oct 2025

Managed visual layout and asset production for learning modules within a government contract at the Defense Language Institute (DLI). Standardized curriculum graphics and media assets for consistency across 14+ language pipelines, coordinating deliverables and deadlines in Airtable.

Wiser Solutions – Senior Designer

Remote | Apr 2022 – Mar 2023

Managed production assets and design-system consistency across a suite of digital applications, following corporate brand guidelines and template structures. Collaborated with remote teams to streamline asset handoffs and reduce file errors.

Axway – Senior Designer

Remote | Mar 2018 – Apr 2022

Designed and built branded layouts across global web properties and physical/digital marketing campaigns. Standardized corporate visual output through template-driven design systems, improving team asset delivery times.

Kiteworks – Product Designer

Palo Alto, CA | Aug 2014 – Feb 2018

Oversaw production-ready asset delivery for a core enterprise web platform, working closely with engineering. Maintained design-system parameters to keep assets consistent with functional and typographic standards.

FastPencil – Creative Lead

Campbell, CA | Oct 2011 – May 2014

Led typographic systems and interior/cover design for 50+ books annually. Coordinated with commercial print vendors and self-publishing platforms (including KDP and IngramSpark) to keep first-pass file acceptance high.

McDill Associates – Print Production Manager

Soquel, CA | Sep 2008 – Nov 2011

Designed packaging and managed print production workflows for national brands, including Costco, Martinelli's, and Rainbow Light. Built and verified packaging dielines, handled spot color separations, and coordinated with printers and paper suppliers for on-time retail rollouts.

West Marine – Prepress Manager

Watsonville, CA | Jan 2002 – Aug 2008

Designed, built, and optimized press-ready files for 800+ page national retail catalogs. Managed the prepress workflow, including preflighting, color management, and pagination/imposition layout. Managed print vendor relationships across years of high-volume seasonal deliveries.

EDUCATION

University of California, Santa Cruz – Coursework in Art, Design & Visual Studies